

The River Answers Back: The Second Attempt

河流的回应：第二次尝试

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The second attempt used the **same set of** instruments in a different **environment**, and the **total** looked modest on paper. “We are not building a **nuclear plant**,” the director said. “We are trying to keep one **island of dry ground** dry.” A **pair of** boots, a **narrow pack**, and a **straight** line on a map: that was the whole plan.

The **environmental setting** was the difficulty. “The **resistance of** this soil to water is a **mathematical** joke,” the geologist said. “The **rain** will **soak** it, and the **wet** season will **destroy** the **shore** road.” The **destruction of** the last **shed** by the flood was still visible from the station.

The team measured the **steam** and the **emission of** the old pump, and found the **discharge of** warm water into the **narrow** channel. “A **revolutionary** approach is not needed,” the boatman said. “A **passive** one is. The **tolerance of** this bank is almost used up.”

The **despair of** the second week was real: a **nest of** birds drowned in the ditch, a **fountain of** mud in the yard, and the **calm surface of** the canal hiding a **soak of** water underneath. “The **surroundings** do not care about our schedule,” Maya wrote.

The **greenhouse** on the ridge had survived, and **its salty liter of** water had condensed by morning. “**Excite** the volunteers **with** the small successes,” the director said. “The big ones are rare, and the small ones **contain** the whole method.”

The second attempt added **discrimination** to the model: **eight** sites, **seven** gauges, **two** banks, and one rule. A **bit of oil** on the hinge **of** the gate, a **drive** to the west **shore**, and the **plant** on the riverbed were all part **of** the **same activity**. **Its** **might** was **its** modesty, and it was, **probably**, the last attempt **of** the season. The **essential** point was the **integration of** the **two** surveys, and the **power of** the argument was **against** a **soluble** answer: **five** trees, one **ass**, and a bitter joke about the weather. The **tree** by the gate and the sediment in the water had to be measured in the **same** week, and the whole attempt was **probably** a lesson in humility rather than a plan.

中文翻译

第二次尝试使用同一套仪器，但环境不同，而总量在纸面上看起来不大。“我们不是在建一座核电站，”主管说，“我们只是想让一座干地的孤岛保持干燥。”一双靴子、一个狭窄的背包，以及地图上一条直线：这就是全部方案。

环境的背景设置就是困难所在。“这片土壤对水的抵抗力是个数学笑话，”地质学家说，“雨水会把它浸透，而湿季会毁掉岸边的路。”上一场洪水毁掉的那间棚屋，从站里还能看见。

团队测量了旧水泵的蒸汽和排放，并发现了温水排入那条狭窄河道的情况。“不需要革命性的做法，”船夫说，“需要一个被动的做法。这片河岸的容忍度几乎用尽了。”

第二周的绝望是真实的：沟渠里一窝被淹死的鸟、院子里一股泥的喷泉，以及运河平静水面上掩盖着的一层浸水。“周围的环境不在乎我们的时间表，”曼雅写道。

山脊上的温室活了下来，它那一公升咸水到早上已经凝结了。“用小小的成功去激励志愿者，”主管说，“大成功很罕见，而小成功里包含着整套方法。”

第二次尝试给模型加上了辨别力：八个地点、七台水位计、两岸，以及一条规则。门铰链上的一点油、一趟去西岸的车程，以及河床上的植物，都属于同一项活动。它的力量在于它的谦虚，而这大概是这一季的最后一次尝试。要紧的一点是两份调查的整合，而论证的力量是针对一个可溶解的答案：五棵树、一头驴，以及一个关于天气的苦涩玩笑。门口那棵树和水里的沉积物必须在同一周测量，而整次尝试大概是一堂关于谦逊的课，而不是一个计划。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
same seɪm POS: a	a. 相同的, 同样的; pron. 相同的人(或事物); adv. 同样地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. same in identity; a. closely similar or comparable in kind or quality or quantity or degree; s. unchanged in...
set set POS: n	n. 日落, 同伙, 组合, 集合, 装置; vt. 放, 安置, 放置, 设定, 使凝结, 点燃, 确定, 点缀, 使就位, 树立, 分配... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of things of the same kind that belong together and are so used; n. (mathematics) an abstract colle...
oil ɔɪl POS: n	n. 油, 石油, 油画颜料; vt. 涂油于, 使融化成油状, 加油于; vi. 加燃油, 融化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slippery or viscous liquid or liquefiable substance not miscible with water; n. oil paint containing pigm...
environment ɪnˈvaɪrənmənt POS: n	n. 环境, 外界, 围绕; [计] 环境 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the totality of surrounding conditions; n. the area in which something exists or lives
environmental ɪnˌvaɪərənˈmentəl POS: a	a. 周围的, 环境的; [经] 环境的, 环保的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to the external conditions or surroundings; a. concerned with the ecological effects of alte...
total ˈtəʊtl̩ POS: a	a. 全体的, 总的, 全然的; vt. 计算...的总和, 共计为; vi. 合计; n. 总数, 全体, 合计; adv. 统统 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. add up in number or quantity; v. determine the sum of; v. damage beyond the point of repair
island ˈaɪlənd POS: n	n. 岛, 岛屿, 孤立地区, 安全岛; vt. 使成岛状, 孤立 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a land mass (smaller than a continent) that is surrounded by water; n. a zone or area resembling an island
essential ɪˈsenʃəl POS: n	n. 要素, 要点, 本质; a. 必要的, 重要的, 本质的; [计] 本质冒险 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. absolutely necessary; vitally necessary; a. basic and fundamental; a. being or relating to or containing the...
nuclear ˈnjuːklɪə POS: a	a. 核子的, 原子能的, 核的, 中心的; [医] 核的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (weapons) deriving destructive energy from the release of atomic energy; a. of or relating to or constituti...
pair peə POS: n	n. 一双, 一对, 一副; v. (使)成对 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a set of two similar things considered as a unit; n. two people considered as a unit; n. a poker hand with 2...
destroy dɪˈstrɔɪ POS: vt	vt. 破坏, 毁坏, 消灭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. do away with, cause the destruction or undoing of; v. destroy completely; damage irreparably; v. put (an ani...
rain reɪn POS: n	n. 雨, 下雨, 雨天; vi. 下雨; vt. 使大量落下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. water falling in drops from vapor condensed in the atmosphere; n. drops of fresh water that fall as precipi...
straight streɪt POS: n	n. 直线, 直; a. 直的, 笔直的, 正直的, 直接的, 连续的, 整齐的; adv. 直接地, 立即, 不断地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a poker hand with 5 consecutive cards (regardless of suit); s. successive (without a break); a. having no de...
narrow ˈnæərəʊ POS: n	n. 狭窄部分, 隘路; a. 狭窄的, 仔细的, 有限的, 勉强的, 狭隘的, 手紧的; vi. 变窄; vt. 使变狭窄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a narrow strait connecting two bodies of water; v. make or become more narrow or restricted; a. not wide; s. ...
setting ˈsetɪŋ POS: n	n. 环境, 背景, 布景, 镶嵌, 调整, 沉落, 一副餐具; [计] 设置 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the context and environment in which something is set; n. the state of the environment in which a situation...
resistance rɪˈzɪstəns POS: n	n. 抵抗力, 反抗, 耐力, 阻力, 电阻; [化] 抵抗; 抗性; 阻力; 抗药性; 电阻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the action of opposing something that you disapprove or disagree with; n. any mechanical force that tends t...
pack pæk POS: n	n. 包裹, 一伙, 一副, 背包, 包装; vt. 包装, 捆扎, 塞满, 压紧, 挑选; vi. 包装货物, 挤, 群集, 被包装; [计]... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a complete collection of similar things; n. a convenient package or parcel (as of cigarettes or film); n. a...
wet wet POS: n	n. 湿气, 潮湿, 水分, 雨天; a. 湿的, 潮的, 搞错的, 下雨的, 反对禁酒的; vi. 变湿; vt. 使...湿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to become wet; v. make one's bed or clothes wet by urinating; a. covered or soaked with a liquid such...
destruction dɪˈstrʌkʃən POS: n	n. 破坏, 毁灭; [医] 破坏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the termination of something by causing so much damage to it that it cannot be repaired or no longer exist...
steam stiːm POS: n	n. 蒸汽, 精力; a. 蒸汽的; vi. 蒸发, 行驶, 发怒; vt. 蒸, 煮, 散发 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. water at boiling temperature diffused in the atmosphere; v. emit steam; v. rise as vapor; v. get very angry

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emission i'miʃən POS: n	n. 发射, 射出, 发行; [医] 发射, 遗精 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of emitting; causing to flow forth; n. the release of electrons from parent atoms; n. the occurrence...
revolutionary ˌrevə'lju:ʃənəri POS: n	n. 革命者, 革命党人; a. 革命的, 革命性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. markedly new or introducing radical change; a. relating to or having the nature of a revolution; a. advocati...
discrimination dis.krimi'neiʃən POS: n	n. 差别, 歧视, 辨别力; [化] 鉴别 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. unfair treatment of a person or group on the basis of prejudice; n. the cognitive process whereby two or mo...
integration ˌinti'greiʃən POS: n	n. 综合, 与环境协调的行为, 集成; [化] 集成; 整合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the action of incorporating a racial or religious group into a community; n. an operation used in the calcu...
shore ʃɔ: POS: n	n. 海岸, 海滨, 斜撑柱; vt. 把...送上岸, 支撑, 支持 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the land along the edge of a body of water; n. a beam or timber that is propped against a structure to prov...
nest nest POS: n	n. 巢, 窝, 休息所, 隐蔽处; vi. 筑巢, 找鸟巢; vt. 为...设窝, 使套叠; [计] 嵌套 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure in which animals lay eggs or give birth to their young; n. a kind of gun emplacement; n. a cosy...
calm kɑ:m POS: n	n. 平稳, 风平浪静; a. 平静的, 冷静的; vi. 平静下来, 镇静; vt. 使平静 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make calm or still; v. become quiet or calm, especially after a state of agitation; s. not agitated; without...
ass æs POS: n	n. 驴, 傻瓜, 笨蛋, 屁股; [计] 模拟仿真系统 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a pompous fool; n. hardy and sure-footed animal smaller and with longer ears than the horse
discharge dis'tʃɑ:dʒ POS: vt	vt. 卸下, 放出, 解雇, 拔染, 履行, 放电; vi. 卸货, 流出; n. 卸货, 流出, 放电 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sudden giving off of energy; n. the act of venting; n. a substance that is emitted or released; n. any of...
shed ʃed POS: n	n. 车棚, 小屋, 脱落之物, 分水岭; vt. 使流出, 放射, 脱落, 散发, 摆脱; vi. 流出, 散布, 脱落 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an outbuilding with a single story; used for shelter or storage; v. get rid of; v. cast off hair, skin, horn...
drown draʊn POS: vi	vi. 淹死; vt. 把...淹死, 淹没 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. get rid of as if by submerging; v. die from being submerged in water, getting water into the lungs, and asp...
passive 'pæsiʋ POS: a	a. 消极的, 被动的, 冷漠的, 顺从的, 无源的; [医] 被动的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. lacking in energy or will; s. peacefully resistant in response to injustice; a. expressing that the subject...
tolerance 'tɒlərəns POS: n	n. 宽容, 忍受, 容忍, 容许量, 公差; [计] 允许误差 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the power or capacity of an organism to tolerate unfavorable environmental conditions; n. the act of tolera...
despair di'speə POS: n	n. 绝望, 失望; vi. 绝望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state in which all hope is lost or absent; n. the feeling that everything is wrong and nothing will turn...
mathematical ˌmæθə'mætikl POS: a	a. 数学的, 精确的; [机] 数学上的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or pertaining to or of the nature of mathematics; s. beyond question; s. statistically possible though hi...
soak səʊk POS: n	n. 浸, 湿透, 大雨; vt. 使上下湿透, 浸, 吸入, 吸收, 浸洗掉; vi. 浸泡, 渗透 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the process of becoming softened and saturated as a consequence of being immersed in water (or other liqui...
surroundings sə'raɪndɪŋz POS: n	n. 环境, 周围的事物; [化] 环境 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the environmental condition; n the area in which something exists or lives; v extend on all sides of simultan...
greenhouse 'ɡri:nhaʊs POS: n	n. 温室 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a building with glass walls and roof; for the cultivation and exhibition of plants under controlled condit...
fountain 'faʊntɪn POS: n	n. 水源, 源, 喷泉, 泉水, 本源; [医] 泉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure from which an artificially produced jet of water arises; n. an artificially produced flow of wa...
excite ik'sait POS: vt	vt. 刺激, 使兴奋, 激励 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. arouse or elicit a feeling; v. raise to a higher energy level; v. produce a magnetic field in

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
salty 'sp:lti POS: a	a. 有盐分的, 咸味浓的, 海洋的, 辛辣的, 有经验的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. containing or filled with salt; s. one of the four basic taste sensations; like the taste of sea water
liter 'li:tə POS: n	n. 公升; [化] 升 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a metric unit of capacity, formerly defined as the volume of one kilogram of pure water under standard con...
soluble 'sɒljubl POS: a	a. 溶解的, 可溶解的, 可以解决的; [医] 溶解的, 可溶的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (of a substance) capable of being dissolved in some solvent (usually water); a. susceptible of solution or...
condense kən'dens POS: vt	vt. 使浓缩, 使压缩, 缩短; vi. 浓缩, 凝结 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. undergo condensation; change from a gaseous to a liquid state and fall in drops; v. remove water from; v. ca...